

**ZSCALER****OUTPERFORM**ZS US ■ PRICE USD214.6* ■ TARGET PRICE **USD230** (UPSIDE 7%)

FLASH NOTE

CRO transition: Will Ross Tackett continue to execute ZS' strategy?

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Research Analyst & Publishing Entities

Andrew DeGasper BNP Paribas Securities Corp.⁽¹⁾ (+1) 917 472 4745 andrew.degasper@us.bnpparibas.com**What happened?**

Zscaler announced after hours that CRO Mike Rich would step down from his role due to personal reasons. In his place, Head of Worldwide Sales Ross Tackett was named his successor. ZS shares are down 4% AH. While the news is disappointing, the impact to Zscaler's sales momentum may be contained given the incoming CRO also joined from ServiceNow and appears to be aligned with Mr. Rich's strategy.

BNPP View:

A CRO transition is often viewed negatively. We wondered if an announcement could have been coming during results two weeks ago, particularly after management flagged the departure of two executives the previous quarter. We are always concerned that a new CRO could inevitably bring turnover in sales executives, and while the timing of this announcement could have been better, we believe it is likely timed to coincide with its upcoming analyst day (scheduled for October 6). Current CRO Mike Rich brought several changes that have yielded fruit, including upgrading its salesforce to a ServiceNow-like model (Platform driven, reorganizing territory by account, verticalizing by industry, etc). This has led to an improvement in ARR metrics since 2024.

But the new CRO appears to be cut from the same cloth. Incoming CRO Ross Tackett is currently Head of Worldwide Sales and joined Zscaler three years ago with Mr. Rich. We believe he is unlikely to meaningfully shift the outgoing CRO's strategy and, given they worked together at ServiceNow before, likely commands some loyalty with senior sales leaders. Importantly, we note Mr. Rich will stay with the company through the end of year, which should allay fears his departure is sudden and he is taking another role. We note language in the 8K stating that Mr. Rich would be receiving some form of severance benefits appear to confirm this view.

Investment case, valuation and risks

Zscaler (Outperform, Target Price USD230)

Investment case

ZS is a pioneer in the development of non-firewall network security architecture. Positive checks and improved adoption of ZTE should push growth toward mid-20% and re-rate the shares higher.

Valuation methodology

We value ZS shares on 9x CY27 EV/sales, which implies 2.9% FCF yield.

Risks

To the upside:

If the company is able to implement its sales strategy very quickly and sales reps are able to be productive within 6 months, growth could return to mid-20% range.

To the downside:

If Zscaler's competitors become more aggressive while the company is still ramping up its sales strategy, growth could slow below current consensus estimates.

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ServiceNow	NOW US	2; 3; 4; 8
Zscaler	ZS US	/

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Ratings	Stocks coverage		Investment Banking Services Within the previous 12 months	
	Counts	%*	Counts	%
Outperform (Buy)	730	52	163	22
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Underperform (Sell)	203	15	38	19

* Please note that the percentages might not add up to 100% because of rounding.

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Price and Ratings Chart

Zscaler



Source: BNP Paribas

Historical rating & target price changes

Date & Time of Dissemination (London time)	Rating (1)	Target Price	Closing Price	Key Changes	Person(s) Involved
27 May 2026 05:40	+	USD230.00	USD126.41	TP down	A. DeGasperi, A. Friedman, J. Pearson
27 Feb. 2026 11:17	+	USD250.00	USD146.99	TP down	A. DeGasperi, A. Friedman, J. Pearson
15 Jan. 2026 11:03	+	USD270.00	USD210.58	TP down	A. DeGasperi, A. Friedman, J. Pearson
3 Sep. 2025 11:04	+	USD330.00	USD270.58	TP up	A. DeGasperi
30 May 2025 11:07	+	USD300.00	USD275.70	TP up	A. DeGasperi, A. Friedman
28 Apr. 2025 11:14	+	USD260.00	USD215.58	Rating up, TP up	A. DeGasperi, A. Friedman
6 Mar. 2025 13:38	=	USD215.00	USD202.16	TP up	A. DeGasperi, A. Friedman
8 Oct. 2024 06:02	=	USD180.00	USD172.13	Initiation of coverage	A. DeGasperi, A. Friedman, S. Slowinski, B. Castillo-Bernaus

(1) With effect from 23 September 2024, BNP Paribas changed its research rating system - please refer to the 'Explanation of Research Ratings'.

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